DSSG Berlin

Challenge Brief — Federated Data Pool: an MCP Server for German Social-Service Data

DSSG Berlin × DSSG NYC Remote Datathon · 23–25 Oct 2026

Partner: Civic Data Lab (Deutscher Caritasverband) together with AWO and other welfare organisations.
Data: MIT licence, no NDA required.

1 Context

People looking for help — and the organisations, journalists and administrations supporting them — face a fragmented landscape: every welfare organisation keeps its own directory. The **Federated Data Pool** (*Föderierter Datenpool*) harmonises heterogeneous sources — Caritas, AWO, the DHS addiction-help directory, the Sozialplattform and Destatis debt counselling — into one shared directory. The data pool is not finished: it keeps growing, even while you are hacking.

Your mission: make this data usable by AI assistants through a **Model Context Protocol (MCP) server**, so anyone can get information and further required insights related to these welfare organisations.

2 Data

Entity (file)	Rows	Main fields	Links to
Einrichtung / facility (`einrichtungSchema.csv`)	168	name, category, phone, e-mail, opening hours, service description, accessibility	address, Träger
Angebot / service offer (`angebotSchema.csv`)	99	name, category, code, audience, area served	provider → facility
Adresse / address (`adresseSchema.csv`)	108	street, postcode, locality, latitude/longitude	–
Träger / provider organisation (`traegerSchema.csv`)	4	name, homepage	address

Known data issues and limitations

- Around 80 % of the facilities have no phone number, e-mail address or opening hours.
- Opening hours and service descriptions are free text, not structured values.
- The locality field has variants for the same city ("Berlin", "Berlin-Mitte", "Berlin-Wedding").
- The prototype covers central Berlin only; a nationwide extension is planned.

The same data is also available through other interfaces, for example GraphQL or SPARQL.

3 Example questions (from the partner)

- **Citizens:** "My son is withdrawn at school — where is the nearest youth counselling?" · "Is Kita XY open right now?" · "I can't pay my rent — who can help?"
- **Social organisations:** "Which of our records are incomplete or outdated — what should we fix first?" · "Which districts have no youth counselling in our network?"
- **Journalists / administration:** "Where are the gaps in addiction-counselling coverage?" · "Where does this field value come from?"

Some questions need data beyond this snapshot (nationwide coverage, time series, demographics). Be creative here, but only combine reliable sources such as official statistics or open government data.

4 Tracks — open to any team or individual

An MCP server with a first set of tools already exists: github.com/Atrash87/awo-mcp-production.

Track	What you do
1 Build your own server	Rebuild the reference architecture from scratch: inspect data → DataLoader → DataRepository → FastMCP server → connect it to an AI client (e.g. Claude Desktop).
2 Basic tools & benchmark	Implement the base tools the use cases need, compare them with the reference code, and benchmark several LLMs on a shared set of test questions (correct answer, right tool, tokens, latency).
3 Extend the server	Add tools, resources and prompts for uncovered use cases: nearby search by coordinates, "open now", audience and category filters, gap analysis by postcode, data-quality ranking.
4 Grow the dataset	The pool grows by adding further entries in the same schema. Build a tool that takes submitted records in their original format, maps them onto the pool's schema, validates them, and returns entries that can be added to this dataset directly.
5 New use cases	Go beyond the use cases above: multilingual and accessibility-aware search, and combination with other data sources and statistics.